

1 Listen Music Player

Well, if nothing else, the name is straightforward!

You do listen to music, don't you? Coded in Python, Listen is a full-fledged music player and manager tool for GNOME. If you haven't used Listen before, you will find it to be a cross between Rhythmbox and Banshee. The interface is divided into three panes: the extreme left pane is the playlist, the middle pane is the navigation console while the one on the extreme right is the track information section. All in all, Listen is a wonderful music player. It lets you manage your podcasts as well as browse *Last.fm* and Shoutcast directories.

Link: <http://www.listen-project.org/>

2 Banshee

Banshee is not a new app but has been around since 2005. It can sync devices as well as scan your hard drive for music files. Just plug in your Android phone or iPad, and Banshee will take care of the rest (yes, I have actually seen it detect an iPad, out of the box). Beyond that, Banshee can also help you manage playlists and organ collection. Plus, it supports video formats as well – though it is best known for its audio playing capabilities.

Link: <http://banshee.fm/>

3 Miro

Consider Miro to be the ultimate video player that you will ever need! It can play videos, support multiple file formats, as well as connect to the Internet to help you grab the video of your choice! Miro comes with its own 'Channel Guide' to help you access online video sources, such as Hulu.com.



A look at Miro

You can also buy music from online stores directly within Miro, connect and sync to your Android phone or Kindle Fire, as well as download stuff using torrents. If you love watching videos and movies on your computer, Miro is must-have software.

Link: <http://www.getmiro.com/>

4 VLC Media Player

VLC Media Player has become a household name, when it comes to music players. It is an open source and cross-platform multimedia software that lets you listen to your music collection, watch videos from DVDs as well as your hard drive, and so on. It plays most file formats



RIDING THE POPULARITY WAVE: VLC media player

without bugging you for codecs, and also comes with streaming capabilities.

On the downside, VLC Media Player severely lacks media managing and organising capabilities, which are easily found in the likes of Banshee or even Miro.

Link: <http://www.videolan.org/vlc/index.html>

5 Rhythmbox

Rhythmbox is a music management application for GNOME users. It draws inspiration from Apple iTunes, and also has the ever-powerful GStreamer media framework behind it. It comes with support for channels or junctions such as *Last.fm*, Magnatune and Jamendo, and since it is based on GStreamer, getting it to play multiple file formats is an easy task.

Furthermore, Rhythmbox, just like Banshee, helps you organise your music collection well, and also has the ability to detect devices such as iPods and Android phones.

Link: <http://projects.gnome.org/rhythmbox/>

6 Amarok

Amarok is to KDE what Rhythmbox is to GNOME. A powerful music player, it also has its own share of UNIX and Windows variants. It is based on QT4 and comes with integration for *Last.fm* as well as its own Lyrics Tracker, and lets you build your own database on the basis of your music collection. And just in case it matters, Amarok has a gorgeous icon.

Link: <http://amarok.kde.org/>

7 Totem

Totem is a video player for GNOME environments. Just like Rhythmbox, it also has the GStreamer framework to watch its back. Once you launch Totem, you will probably find it unimpressive and bland—yes, the interface looks right out of the 1990s. However, it is one piece of truly sophisticated software: it comes with its own plug-in for Mozilla Firefox to help you play videos right inside the browser, as well as a video properties' helper for the command line. While Totem can play audio files too, it is best suited for videos.

Link: <http://projects.gnome.org/totem/index.html>

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